

History as a science:

Ibn Khaldun, a medieval Islamic scholar, believed that history should be studied scientifically, like any other subject. He thought historians should:

1. Critically analyze sources and accounts of events.
2. Look for causes and reasons behind historical events.
3. Understand the social, political, and environmental contexts of different nations and times.
4. Be aware of biases and lies in historical records.
5. Compare past and present events to learn from history.

He emphasized the importance of a systematic and objective approach to studying history, much like modern historians do today.

New science of sociology:

Ibn Khaldun's "New Science" is interpreted as the science of human social organization, commonly interpreted as sociology. The fundamental principles of the new science are ¹:

- The subject matter of the new science is human association
- Its problems are the essential modes of culture
- Its method is demonstration
- Its end is making of truth from falsehood in historical reports

Khaldun maintained that he was presenting a new science that consisted of the following areas:

- Human civilization

- Primitive societies
- The states
- The cities
- The crafts
- The occupations
- The sciences

Effect of climate:

Ibn Khaldun believed that climate has a significant impact on human habits, culture, and society. He argued that:

1. Temperature affects human character: He believed that people living in hot climates tend to be more relaxed and lethargic, while those in cold climates are more energetic and active.

2. Climate influences physical appearance: He thought that people in hot climates tend to have darker skin, while those in cold climates have lighter skin.

3. Climate shapes economic activities: He believed that climate determines the types of crops that can be grown, which in turn affects the economy and way of life.

4. Climate influences political and social organization: He argued that climate affects the type of political and social structures that develop in a region, with hotter climates leading to more authoritarian governments and colder climates leading to more democratic systems.

5. Climate affects human morals and values: He believed that climate influences the moral and ethical values of a society, with hotter climates leading to more relaxed moral standards and colder climates leading to more strict moral codes.

Conclusion:

Ibn Khaldun's ideas on the impact of climate on human habits and society were revolutionary for his time and remain influential in the fields of sociology, anthropology, and environmental studies.